

Main Senior Citizen Privileges in the Philippines

In the Philippines, a **senior citizen** is generally a **resident Filipino citizen who is at least 60 years old**. The principal law is **Republic Act No. 9994 (Expanded Senior Citizens Act of 2010)**, as amended by later laws including **RA 11916**. The National Commission of Senior Citizens (NCSC) confirms the following major rights and privileges. ([NCSC](#))

PH Main Senior Citizen Privileges

Privilege	Benefit
 Medicines	20% discount + VAT exemption , including certain vaccines and essential medical supplies
 Medical services	20% discount + VAT exemption on qualifying professional fees, medical/dental services, diagnostic and laboratory services in private facilities
 Home health care	20% discount + VAT exemption on qualifying professional home-health services
 Land transportation	20% discount on actual fares for buses, jeepneys, taxis, AUVs, shuttle services, and public railways such as LRT, MRT and PNR
 Domestic air travel	20% discount on actual fare, including applicable advance-booking arrangements
 Domestic sea travel	20% discount on actual fare
 Restaurants	20% discount + VAT exemption on qualifying food, drinks and other consumable items for the senior's exclusive use
 Hotels/lodging	20% discount + VAT exemption on qualifying services
 Entertainment	20% discount + VAT exemption on admission to cinemas, theaters, concert halls, circuses, leisure and amusement facilities
 Funeral/burial services	20% discount + VAT exemption on qualifying funeral and burial services
 Electricity	At least 5% discount on monthly consumption, subject to the 100 kWh limit and other conditions
 Water	At least 5% discount on monthly consumption, subject to the 30 m³ limit and other conditions
 Income tax	Exempt from individual income tax if the senior citizen qualifies as a minimum-wage earner
 Education	Educational assistance such as scholarships, grants, financial aid and subsidies, subject to qualifications
 Government medical services	Free medical/dental services and diagnostic/laboratory services in government facilities, subject to applicable rules
 Vaccination	Free influenza and pneumococcal vaccination for indigent senior citizens
 Express/priority lanes	Express lanes in government and commercial establishments; priority should be given where no express lane exists
 Basic necessities/prime commodities	Special 5% discount on qualified basic necessities and prime commodities, subject to applicable rules and limits
 Social pension	Qualified indigent senior citizens receive at least ₱1,000/month
 PhilHealth	Indigent senior citizens are covered by the national health insurance program
 Social safety nets	Assistance such as food, medicine and financial assistance may be available during economic shocks, disasters and calamities
 Housing	Government housing programs are required to consider the special housing needs of senior citizens
 Employment/livelihood	Government programs provide opportunities for skills development, livelihood and employment
 Geriatric care	Government is required to develop national health programs and geriatric services for older persons

These privileges are summarized directly by the NCSC from the governing laws. ([NCSC](#))

☆ The most commonly used benefit: 20% + VAT exemption

For qualifying purchases, the senior citizen generally receives:

20% discount + exemption from 12% VAT

For example, for a VATable purchase of ₱1,000 **before VAT**:

- Regular price: ₱1,000 + ₱120 VAT = ₱1,120
- Senior citizen discount: 20% of ₱1,000 = ₱200
- Amount payable: **₱800**

The discount is generally for the **exclusive use and enjoyment of the senior citizen**. ([Bir Cdn](#))

If a store already has a promotional discount, the senior citizen may generally avail of the **more favorable applicable discount**, rather than automatically adding the two discounts together. ([NCSC](#))

5% discount is different from the 20% discount

The **5% special discount** applies to qualified **basic necessities and prime commodities (BNPCs)** and is subject to specific rules and purchase limits. It is **not simply another 5% that can be added to the 20% senior discount**. ([Bir Cdn](#))

₱1,000 monthly social pension

This is important: **not every senior citizen automatically receives ₱1,000 per month**.

The current DSWD Social Pension program is for **qualified indigent senior citizens**. The amount was increased from ₱500 to **₱1,000 per month** under RA 11916. ([DSWD](#))

Generally, qualified beneficiaries include seniors who are 60+, frail/sickly or with disability, have no permanent source of income, have no qualifying pension, and lack regular family support for basic needs. ([DSWD](#))

Senior Citizen ID

An **OSCA Senior Citizen ID** can be used to establish entitlement to the benefits. The NCSC also now provides a **Digital National Senior Citizens ID through the eGovPH app**, intended to be usable for senior-citizen privileges nationwide. ([NCSC](#))

One recent change worth knowing: **senior citizens no longer need to present a purchase booklet to obtain the 20% discount on prescription medicines**, following DOH Administrative Order No. 2024-0017.

Republic Act No. 11982 (RA 11982) is the **Expanded Centenarians Act of 2024** in the Philippines. It amended the earlier **Centenarians Act of 2016 (RA 10868)** by extending government cash benefits to Filipino senior citizens who reach certain milestone ages, not just 100 years old. ([Lawphil](#))

Benefits under RA 11982

Age Reached	Cash Gift
80 years old	₱10,000
85 years old	₱10,000
90 years old	₱10,000
95 years old	₱10,000
100 years old	₱100,000 + Letter of Felicitation from the President

These benefits apply to qualified Filipino citizens, whether residing in the Philippines or abroad. ([ncsc.gov.ph](#))

Purpose of the Law

The law aims to:

- Recognize and honor the longevity and contributions of Filipino senior citizens.
- Provide financial assistance to elderly Filipinos.
- Expand government support beyond centenarians to include octogenarians (80s) and nonagenarians (90s). ([bongrevillajr.ph](#))

When It Became Law

RA 11982 was signed on **February 26, 2024**. ([Lawphil](#))